RSS Digest
Generated at: 2026-11-05 15:45:35

1. datasette-llm 0.1a10
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-04T15:26:02+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/4/datasette-llm/
Release: datasette-llm 0.1a10 Fixes a bug that affected my agent.datasette.io demo site, where the set of available LLM models was not correctly restricted to just those in the configuration. Tags: datasette , llm

2. datasette-apps 0.3a0
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-04T00:29:36+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/4/datasette-apps/
Release: datasette-apps 0.3a0 Datasette Apps adds support for hosting and editing custom HTML applications inside of Datasette. These can be created by hand, but it’s easier to create them using LLMs via Datasette Agent . This release improves that integration: Apps can now be tagged in Datasette Agent chat messages by typing # , which autocompletes from the apps the user has permission to view. New app_add_stored_queries() and app_remove_stored_queries() tools let the agent manage which stored queries an app is allowed to call. Granting a write query requires approval from the user first. app_create() now checks that each requested stored query exists and that the user can view it, and asks the user to approve any write queries before the app is created. The "View app" buttons shown by the agent tools, and the links on # app references, now open the app full screen in the Datasette Agent panel. Tags: datasette , datasette-agent , datasette-apps

3. datasette-agent 0.5a0
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-03T23:13:45+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/3/datasette-agent/
Release: datasette-agent 0.5a0 This is a significant release of Datasette Agent . The most notable new feature is called the panel - it lets the agent chat open and then sit next to pages from Datasette, for example a table or query page. When combined with datasette-apps this means you can prompt a database-backed app into existence and then modify it from the chat that sits next to that app. You can try it by signing in with your GitHub account to agent.datasette.io . Tags: projects , datasette , datasette-agent

4. This Election Will Not Look Surprising in History
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-04T15:15:51Z
Link: https://apple.news/Afq6SKrYkTcCEHrCEQmxm5A?web_embed_link=aHR0cHM6Ly9uZXdzLWFzc2V0cy5hcHBsZS5jb20vZW1iZWRzLzY2ZDQzYzg0LTMyMWYtNGQ0Ny05Mzk4LWE3NjE3NDgwZWE2Yi9pbmRleC5odG1sI2NvbnRleHQ9EQUwmc3RpY2t5PWZhbHNlJmVmZmVjdD1ub25lJmxpZ2h0X2JnX2NvbG9yPWU5ZWNmMiZkYXJrX2JnX2NvbG9yPTJkM2CZzY29wZT11cyZvcmlnaW49c2hhcnJvdyZsaXZlYWN0aXZpdGllcz10cnVlJm5mZl9jaWQ9NTZjMjQ1OTQtNDIxNC00NDM0LTlhNTgtNWE1YTIxM2ZkMTBi
This striking map from Apple News tells the story of the magnitude of the shift since 2024. The late Lindsey Graham, on Twitter back in May 2016 (punctuation sic): If we nominate Trump, we will get destroyed.....and we will deserve it. The wheels of history grind slowly, but they do grind. By the time of his death, Graham was amongst the lickspittlest of Trump?s GOP toadies. Graham?s idiot sister ran for his vacant Senate seat in South Carolina and lost . Former representative Liz Cheney, at the January 6 hearings in 2021 : I say this to my Republican colleagues who are defending the indefensible. There will come a day when Donald Trump is gone, but your dishonor will remain. Winston Churchill, perhaps apocryphally : Americans can always be trusted to do the right thing, once all other possibilities have been exhausted. Abraham Lincoln : You can fool some of the people all of the time, and all of the people some of the time, but you can not fool all of the people all of the time. ?

5. ?Political Reckoning Shatters Trump?s Grip on Washington?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-04T14:56:47Z
Link: https://www.wsj.com/politics/elections/a-political-reckoning-shatters-trumps-grip-on-washington-bd3c7705?st=xABDit
Aaron Zitner, reporting for the Rupert Murdoch-owned Wall Street Journal: Rarely in American politics has a president traded away so much political support so quickly. The losses that Republicans suffered on Tuesday marked one of the most decisive repudiations of a president in modern history. President Trump had re-entered the White House with advantages he lacked in his first term: a victory in the popular vote, a cadre of aides eager to expand his authority and cultural currency that had NFL players doing the ?Trump dance? in the end zone. Only two years later, his political standing has collapsed, all because of a dramatic miscalculation of his power to shape events. A war of choice with Iran and tariffs imposed on U.S. trading partners betrayed his promise to avoid foreign entanglements and tame inflation. His extraordinary interventions in his party?s primaries left Republicans with a set of unusually weak candidates. The Democrats went from out of power in Washington to a massive majority in the House and an apparent 55-45 or even 56-44 majority in the Senate. Keisha Lance Bottoms was elected the first black woman governor in history ? in Georgia . By a 9-point margin. Texa...

6. Safari 27.3 Beta Adds Vertical Tabs and Adaptive Dark Mode
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-03T19:26:41Z
Link: https://www.macrumors.com/2026/11/03/ios-27-3-safari/
Juli Clover, MacRumors: With iOS 27.3, iPadOS 27.3, and macOS Golden Gate 27.3, Apple is making major updates to Safari. The browser is getting a Vertical Tabs layout, which can be used instead of the standard horizontal tab bar. It?s a change that pairs well with the iPhone Duo?s larger display, but it is available across iPhone, iPad, and Mac. Vertical Tabs are located on the left side of the display and use icons by default to save space, but there is an option to make the tab bar wider to show website titles as well. Vertical Tabs work with both Topics and Tab Groups to keep things organized. Topics are created when automatic Apple Intelligence tab sorting is turned on in iOS 27. Pinning tabs by dragging, quickly swapping between Tab Groups, and other features also continue to work. I got an advance demo of this last week and I?m really looking forward to trying it. I?ve gotten very used to horizontal tabs over the years, but a long time ago I was a devoted user of the Omni Group?s OmniWeb browser, of which one of my favorite features was its vertical tabs. That was so long ago, the tabs went in a drawer . Apple is adding Adaptive Dark Mode for websites that don?t have a dark...

7. Goodhart’s Law, but We Already Spent All Our Money
Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Wed, 04 Nov 2026 08:00:00 GMT
Link: https://idiallo.com/blog/we-spent-all-our-money-goodharts-law
Here is how to make any sports fan angry. Basketball is just a bunch of grown men bouncing a ball and throwing it into a basket. Football is a bunch of grown men running on grass trying to kick a ball into a net, yes that football. And baseball... Oh boy, baseball. I’ve used these lines many times to piss people off and to justify my complete lack of athletic feats. But the counter-argument I always get is that football is a multi-billion-dollar industry, or that a specific player makes more money than I will ever see in a lifetime. If I counter that video games are just for kids, because of course I’d say that, I get a similar response: Video games make more money than all of these sports combined. It’s all true. But nobody is telling me why basketball is important. Nobody tells me how good the game is, how people bond over it, how it brings a community together, or that it is simply healthy to stay active. Whether it’s basketball, football, video games, or (God forgive me) baseball, it all boils down to the exact same measuring stick: how much money the activity generates. If the importance of a thing is only measured by how much money it makes, then we will aim to make more mon...

8. There are things with ranks, but it?s not always clear what the ranks mean
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 04 Nov 2026 15:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261104-00/?p=112830/

The problem with documentation written by people who know the feature too well. The post There are things with ranks, but it?s not always clear what the ranks mean appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Want to Rent an Internet Address at the White House?
Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Thu, 05 Nov 2026 04:36:17 +0000
Link: https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/11/want-to-rent-an-internet-address-at-the-white-house/
Several staffers at the White House are using computers or mobile devices equipped with residential proxy services that render their internet address available for others to rent, security experts warned today. One of the proxy services is a Russian company whose founder’s web hosting business was ground zero for cyberattacks against election systems in Arizona and Illinois in 2016.

10. Book Review: Practice by Rosalind Brown ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Wed, 04 Nov 2026 12:34:07 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/11/book-review-practice-by-rosalind-brown/
I have a simple rule - if I meet someone at a party and they say they’ve written a book, then I will immediately buy that book. It’s a strategy which has worked out well; leading me to some truly interesting and delightful prose. Rosalind Brown (a fellow UEA graduate) has written a stunning little book. Practice is an almost Proustian meander through a day-in-the-life of a young woman going?

11. This Week in Source Control: 4 November 2026
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-11-04T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/11/04/this-week-in-source-control.html
This week?s version control and forge news, gathered from release feeds for source control clients and forges, the Lobsters vcs tag , Hacker News, and my boosts on Mastodon . Package management news is in the Saturday This Week in Package Management roundup. Scaling Scaling Git at OpenAI (Aaron Friel, Taylor Blau and Ted Nyman, OpenAI) describes Pando, a Rust backend for git repositories that now serves all development in OpenAI?s monorepo. Each push is stored as an immutable packfile in blob storage, and each branch update records a ref version in a metadata store, so pushes contend only when they target the same ref. The trade-off is causal consistency, so a client reading several branches can see them at different points in time. When a new branch is pushed, Pando advertises only trunk, which keeps the pushed pack reusable for anyone who already has trunk, and the median pack produced this way was under 20 KiB. On a fetch, Pando sends an empty packfile in the response and lists the packs the client needs as packfile-uri links. The client downloads those packs from a regional cache with a hit rate above 99%. Background compaction merges small packs into larger ones in levels, up...

12. Pluralistic: The AI fatfinger economy has come for my receipts app (04 Nov 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 04 Nov 2026 11:45:02 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/11/04/genius-scan-is-neither/
Today’s links The AI fatfinger economy has come for my receipts app: Every heretofore useful button now summons a useless AI genie. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Army Times v Rumsfeld; RIAA v soccer mom; Skateboard truck table; Internet scare-story prof won’t show her workings; IoT botnet v Liberia; BLM v TPP. Upcoming appearances: Kilkenny, Courtenay, Vancouver, Folkestone, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. The AI fatfinger economy has come for my receipts app (permalink) "AI is being shoved down our throats" can mean any of several things. It can mean that our bosses are demanding that we use AI in reckless or nonsensical ways on the job: https://www.404media.co/manifestos-fear-and-loser-thinking-inside-protons-ai-reckoning/ It can mean that Elon Musk and the NASDAQ have colluded to force ordinary retirement savers to bail

out his emirati and tech oligarch buddies:
https://www.nytimes.com/2026/06/05/technology/spacex-indexes-401k.html These are arguably the most importa...

13. ?It Gives Great Demo?
Source: Jim Nielsen?s Blog | Published: Wed, 04 Nov 2026 19:00:00 GMT
Link: https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/it-gives-great-demo/
There?s that famous video of Steve Jobs explaining why they don?t didn?t make touchscreen MacBooks: We thought about [a touch screen MacBook] years ago. We?ve done tons of user testing on this and it turns out it doesn?t work! Touch surfaces don?t want to be vertical. It gives great demo. But after a short period of time, you start to fatigue. And after an extended period of time, your arm wants to fall off. It doesn?t work. It?s ergonomically terrible. Touch surfaces want to be horizontal [?] that?s why we?ve perfected our multitouch trackpads over the years. I?m not going to weigh in on the new MacBooks. But what I find specifically intriguing in this video ? and broadly relevant ? is that phrase: ?It gives great demo.? Damn, that is a great line for so much of technology. ?It gives great demo.? Something that looks amazing when it?s presented to you, but in practical day-to-day use you discover, ?Actually this is kinda terrible.? Demo is everything nowadays. Whatever can garner attention. Who cares if it works in practice, does it give great demo? Because demo time is sale time. The purpose of a demo is to get your attention. To make you think about the product and that it exis...

14. Utrecht Ultra 2024 Race Report
Source: Blog ? Daniel Wirtz | Published: Tue, 13 Aug 2024 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://danielwirtz.com/blog/utrecht-ultra-2024-race-report
On August 3rd at 17:55, I found myself amidst a sea of nervous cyclists at the start of the Utrecht Ultra 2024, an ultra-cycling race spanning approximately?

15. Pyrenees Gear Packing List
Source: Blog ? Daniel Wirtz | Published: Fri, 07 Jun 2024 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://danielwirtz.com/blog/pyrenees-bikepacking-gear-packing-list
I recently did a 2-week bikepacking trip to the Spanish Pyrenees. Below you find my packing checklist list of everything I took with me and some commentary on?

16. New Discovery: Readwise & Reader
Source: Blog ? Daniel Wirtz | Published: Thu, 18 Jan 2024 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://danielwirtz.com/blog/readwise-reader
I?ve recently discovered Readwise and Reader, and have become a subscriber after a 30-day trial. Especially the Reader is amazing.